You can also use to_s to convert a symbol to a string; the name and inspect methods perform basically the same conversion.

Symbols respond to the following string-like methods, which are effectively shortcuts for calling to_s so that you don't have to explicitly convert them to a string:

- <=>, and all Comparable methods
- []
- ===
- =~
- capitalize, downcase, swapcase, and upcase
- casecmp and casecmp?
- empty?
- encoding
- end_with?
- length and size
- match and match?

Ruby also gives you Symbol::all_symbols, which returns an array of all Symbols Ruby knows about at the time of the call.